

Solution to Cryptic Crosswords: MS Edition

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1. **SIGMA:** “adds up” refers to a sum, denoted by a capital sigma. “Sigma” is also a term that refers to the guy who wrote these clues.
2. **FERMAT:** “margins are tiny” refers to the backstory relating to Fermat’s Last Theorem. In addition, look at what the initials in the clue spell!
3. **COSINE:** “you” is commonly replaced by “u”, so excluding “u” from “cousin” gets “cosin.” That comes “before starting every,” so we put that before the start of the word every, or the letter “e.”
4. **DIVISOR:** If we look “in the sorted indiv I,” we see that inside the words “indiv I sorted,” there is a string of seven letters that spell “divisor.”
5. **INDUCTION:** The wordplay part is “I’d cut in on rearranged.” So, if we rearrange the letters in “I’d cut in on” to get a word that also means “proofs,” we get “induction.”
6. **COORDINATES:** “synchronizes” is a synonym for “coordinates” as in “to bring multiple elements to work together.” The second half, “labels on a set of axes” refer to the coordinates used to define points in a coordinate system.
7. **MOD:** The key here is “even removes.” If we remove the even letters from “M’lord”, we get our desired result “mod” which is a way to denote a sort of “congruence.”
8. **PRIME:** Usually, when the word “initial” or some form of it is in this type of clue, you look at the first letters of words. In this case, the initials of the last five words are P, R, I, M, and E. This, of course, spells “prime.”
9. **RADICAL:** “Revolutionary” and “radical” are words used to describe someone whose ideas go against the norm. In addition, radicals are another word for “roots”, which are used to cancel out exponents in equations such as $x^4 = 81$.
10. **CENTROID:** Consider “Apple alternative removed and.” “Apple alternative” is “android” which becomes “roid” after you remove “and.” That comes “after a penny” which can also mean a “cent.” Thus, “cent” + “roid” = “centroid.”